

ACADEMIC ENGLISH AND STUDY SKILLS 1.docx

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Assignment Cover Sheet



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3. I understand that failure to meet these guidelines may instigate the Centre's malpractice procedures and risk failure of the unit and / or qualification.

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INTRODUCTION

Journaling is a habit of writing down daily routines, thoughts, and feelings. It can make a positive difference in students' lives. Writing about daily activities and feelings helps reduce stress and allows students to understand themselves better. I chose this topic because I want to learn how the habit of writing every day can bring positive changes to students' lives. In my opinion, keeping a journal regularly improves focus, builds confidence, and encourages personal growth. I also write about my daily routine, thoughts, and feelings in my journal.

Learning Outcome #1

Be able to interpret data from academic texts for a chosen topic.

1.1 Identify an area for a research topic approved by Your line manager/academic supervisor/mentor.

Title: The Advantages of Journaling for Enhancing Students' Personal Development.

Research Focus : This research aims to understand how journaling helps students develop both academically and personally in their daily lives. It also looks at how regular writing can strengthen learning habits and inspire students to think more positively about their education. (Angie, 2025)

Research Objectives: The study aims to understand how daily journaling supports emotional well-being, encourages self-reflection, and helps students stay motivated. It also looks at how journaling strengthens learning habits and develops a positive attitude toward education. (Angie, 2025)

Importance of the research: Journaling helps students express their thoughts and feelings, reduce stress, and understand themselves better. It improves their writing skills and helps them grow personally.(Academy, 2023)

Research Methodology: This study examines the role of daily journaling in students' academic and personal lives. Based on insights from online articles written in my own words, it highlights how regular writing lowers stress, enhances critical thinking, and supports academic achievement.(Lange, 2025)

Evaluation of the Literature: I will review articles on student journaling to show how daily writing helps students reduce stress, improve focus, build confidence, and achieve academic success. (Lange, 2025)

Surveys and Questionnaires: After asking a few students about their journaling habits, they said that they write down everything in their daily routine, including study, sleep, food, exercise, and

even good and bad things. They also plan what they will do the next day. This helps them follow their plans easily. As a result, students' lives become simpler and they improve in different ways.

Data analysis: After collecting responses from the survey and interviews, I will read them carefully and make short notes in my own words. Then, I will try to understand the students' experiences with journaling.

Ethical Considerations: No student will be forced to participate in the survey or interview. All students will be treated with respect. Their information will be kept confidential, and their permission will be taken before using any personal details. This will make the students feel safe and comfortable

1.2 Select appropriate texts for the chosen topic.

Identify Research Need: My research topic is 'The Importance of Journaling for Students' Personal Development'. I want to find out the importance of journaling in improving a student's studies and mental health. To gather important information on this topic, I will take help from various books, articles, and research papers.

Relevant Literature: Research has shown that journaling increases students' self-confidence and increases their focus on their studies. Developing regular journaling habits increases the academic performance of students and keeps them mentally healthy. (Tabac, 2021)

Evaluate the Sources: I chose this article because it contains important information about the benefits of journaling in students' lives, which will be useful in my research. It explains how writing on a daily basis can improve mental clarity, emotional intelligence, and contemplation. The material can be trusted because it was placed on a reputable website by an experienced writer. (Tabac 2021)

Analyse and organize findings: I read the article and identified the main points about how handwriting improves memory, understanding, and learning. Then, I organized the information into categories such as memory improvement and academic progress to make the findings easier to understand. (Balasubramanian, 2024)

1.3 Summarize and evaluate academic texts.

This section summarizes the key points of selected academic texts and assesses their legitimacy, relevance, and usefulness. This allows me to understand how each source contributes to my research on journaling and its benefits for students' academic and personal development.

Summarizing Academic Texts:

1.Read Thoroughly: I carefully read the article to understand how journaling helps with learning and personal development. I identified the main points about academic improvement, self-reflection, and personal growth. Then, I thought about how these ideas relate to my studies. (Meacham, 2021)

2.Break It Down – Journaling for Students:

Step 1: Divide the text into sections

I divided the text about journaling into three main sections: mental health, academic improvement, and personal growth. This made it easier to understand and organize the important ideas.

Mental Health: Mental Health: Gratitude journaling helps reduce stress and negative feelings. Writing about the things we are thankful for helps us think more positively and feel better. So, gratitude journaling is a simple way to improve mental health. (Fekete & Deichert ,2022).

Academic Improvement: Journaling helps students study better. It helps them keep their ideas in order, remember important information, and understand lessons more clearly. It also helps them plan their study goals, follow their progress, and improve their learning step by step. (Lange, 2025)

Personal Growth: Journaling helps people understand themselves better. Writing about their thoughts, feelings, and daily experiences helps them know their goals and strengths. It also helps them improve themselves step by step. (Metivier, 2021)

Step 2: Focus on one section at a time

I tried to see what it discussed as I slowly read each section. I discovered that journaling can help me de-stress and calm my mind under the mental health section.

Step 3: Skip unimportant details

I did not copy all of the lines. I simply wrote the key ideas that I felt were crucial. Journaling, for example, improves my ability to concentrate and comprehend my own thoughts.

Step 4: Make summarizing easier

Identify Main Ideas: Journaling is very helpful for students. It helps them write about their thoughts and feelings. Writing regularly keeps the mind calm, improves focus, and helps them understand themselves better. It also helps them remember what they have learned more easily. (Connections Academy, 2023)

Write a Summary: Journaling is a simple writing habit that supports both study and personal growth. Journalism helps students to think clearly and focus on their studies. By writing regularly, their stress will be reduced and they will be able to understand their progress in various tasks of their daily life.

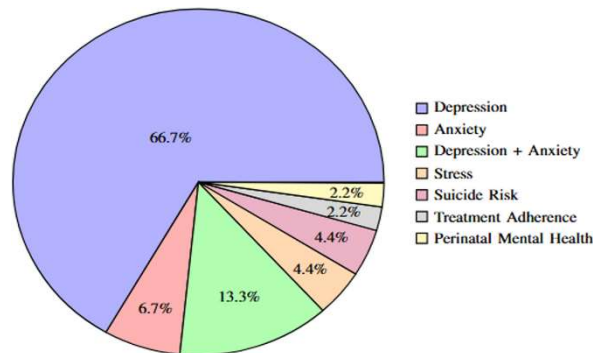
Compare: Effect on Students: Differentiating between those who regularly write down the important tasks of their daily life and those who do not, it is found that students who regularly keep a journal remember their reading more easily and they can understand the progress of their learning, so they can pay more attention to their studies. And those who do not write a journal, their daily routine is messy. They don't know when to follow a routine.

1.4 Interpret Graphs, Charts, and Diagrams.

The chart highlights the positive impact of journaling on students' studies, mental health and personal development.

Chart Type: Pie chart.

Labels: Depression, Anxiety, Stress, and other mental health topics.



(Wajid, Azam and Anwar, 2025)

Data Analysis: The chart shows a depression rate of about 66.7%. It has the highest percentage of depression and anxiety at 13.3% and the percentage of the rest of the subjects is relatively low. (Wajid, Azam and Anwar, 2025)

Contextual Information: The chart shows that when a person feels lonely, his depression and stress increase. Through journaling it is possible to get rid of this depression and all other mental stress.

Summary of Findings: The results indicate that regular journaling can improve students' mental health and help them improve their personal lives and develop mental health.

1.5 Prepare Findings from Interpretation of Texts and Data.

Key Point Summary: Journalism is a useful practice for students. It helps them remember their daily reading, improve their writing skills, and express their thoughts and feelings. Regular journaling can reduce stress, increase focus, and help students understand their personal progress. Overall, journaling supports students' academic learning and personal development. (Connections Academy, 2023)

Contextualizing Results: The results show that other studies also highlight the importance of journaling in students' lives. They mention that journaling helps students reduce stress, maintain a positive mindset, and increase their confidence. Regular journaling also plays an important role in

developing good study habits. As a result, students can achieve success in their studies and daily activities. (University of St. Augustine for Health Sciences, 2020)

Visualize Results and Implications: The results show that journaling helps people think clearly and reduce stress. It also helps them understand their feelings and maintain a positive mindset. Therefore, journaling can be considered a simple and effective habit for improving mental health and creating a better daily life. (Asteroid Health, 2025)

Recommendations :Students should develop journaling as a daily habit. By writing down their thoughts, feelings, and daily experiences, they can better understand themselves. Regular journaling helps students think clearly, solve problems, and improve their self-awareness. (zwhaley, 2018)

Learning Outcome #2

Be able to apply academic Conventions.

2.1 Use ideas and arguments in a clear and logical Manner.

Introduction: I started my assignment by introducing the topic of journaling. I explained the meaning of journaling, its importance, and how it can benefit students in their academic and personal lives.

Body Paragraphs: Then, I discussed the main benefits of journaling and explained how it supports students' learning, mental health, and personal development. I used information from reliable sources to support my ideas and findings.

Conclusion: Finally, I summarized the key points and explained the important role of journaling in improving students' academic, personal, and mental well-being.

2.2 Reference Sources Using the Harvard System in Text and in Bibliography.

Referencing is an essential part of academic writing.. It gives credit to the original authors of ideas and information. It also helps avoid plagiarism and allows readers to find the original sources. In

my assignment, I used the Harvard Referencing System, including both in-text citations and a reference list.

1. In- text Citation: In-text citations are used in the text when we use information or ideas from another source. In the Harvard style, the author’s last name and the publication year are written in brackets.

Paraphrased Information Example: In my assignment: Regular journaling helps students reduce stress, improve study focus, and stay organized (Lange, 2025).

Direct Quotation Example: In my assignment: According to Fekete and Deichert (2022), “a brief gratitude writing intervention decreased stress.”

2. Bibliography/Reference List: The reference list is at the end of my assignment. It contains the full details of all the sources used in this study.

A. Online Articles / Websites

Structure: Author Surname, Initial. (Year). ‘Article Title’, Website Name. Available at: URL (Accessed: Date).

Example from my assignment: Lange, B. (2025). How Journaling Can Improve Your Academic Success. [online] The National Society of Collegiate Scholars. Available at: <https://nscs.org/blog/journaling-can-improve-academic-success> [Accessed: 28 July 2026].

B. Academic Journal Articles

Structure: Author Surname, Initial. (Year). ‘Article Title’, Journal Name, Volume(Issue), pages. Available at: DOI/URL (Accessed: Date).

Example from my assignment: Fekete, E.M. and Deichert, N.T. (2022). ‘A Brief Gratitude Writing Intervention Decreased Stress and Negative Affect During the COVID-19 Pandemic’, Journal of Happiness Studies, 23(6). Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10902-022-00505-6> [Accessed: 29 July 2026].

C. Institutional / Organizational Authors

Structure: Organization Name (Year). ‘Article Title’, Organization Name. Available at: URL (Accessed: Date).

Example from my assignment: Connections Academy (2023). ‘5 Benefits of Journaling for Students’, Connections Academy. Available at: <https://www.connectionsacademy.com/support/resources/article/5-reasons-for-students-to-keep-a-journal/> [Accessed: 29 July 2026].

2.3 Use the Work of Others in Academic Writing.

Academic writing uses other authors’ ideas to make arguments stronger. To avoid plagiarism and give credit to original work, we use three methods: summarizing, paraphrasing, and quoting.

Summarising: Summarizing means to summarize the important things from a large text in your own language.

Example from my assignment: Journaling reduces the stress of students, makes learning easier, and makes life better. (Connections Academy, 2023).

Paraphrasing: Paraphrasing means rewriting someone else’s ideas in our own words while keeping the original meaning unchanged. It allows us to present information in our own way and avoid plagiarism.

Example from my assignment: Regular journaling helps students improve their memory, understand their lessons better, and make their learning process more effective.(Balasubramanian, 2024).

Quoting: Quoting means using the exact words from a source without changing them. This symbol (“ ”) is used to give an accurate recognition of the original formula. This is called a quotation mark.

Example from my assignment: “A brief gratitude writing intervention decreased stress” (Fekete and Deichert, 2022).

2.4 Produce Written Work Following Academic Conventions.

While doing my assignment on journaling, I followed the academic rules and tried to keep my writing clear, concise, and accurate.

Formal Style: I used formal words in my assignments and refrained from using any informal language.

Organized Structure: I have completed my entire work with a clear title, introduction, main discussion, and conclusion.

Citations and References: I follow the Harvard referencing method to correctly name the source and avoid plagiarism.

Editing and Proofreading: I reviewed my work carefully, corrected any mistakes, and tried to make my writing clearer and easier to understand.

Ethical Standards: I used the sources honestly and wrote the ideas in my own words.

Learning Outcome # 3

Be able to extract key Information from lectures, Talks and discussions.

3.1 Utilize Skills to: Take Effective, Full Notes and Reformulate and Synthesize Information Avoiding Plagiarism.

Strategies for Effective Note-Taking -

Prepare Properly: I gathered the necessary information and focused on the importance of journaling.

Use Clear Headings: I organized all the important points using headings and subheadings.

Listen Actively: Before making notes, I went through the key points of different articles and research.

Paraphrase and Summarize: I wrote the information in my own words without copying anything.

Highlight Key Points: I highlighted the benefits of journaling, such as reducing stress, improving focus on studies, and building self-confidence.

Use Short Notes: I have noted the important information in a simple and concise way.

Review Notes: I repeatedly reviewed my notes and tried to get a good understanding of the topics.

Reformulate and Synthesize Information -

Understand the Source: I read the main points well to learn more about journaling.

Take Notes: I tried to highlight the essential details in the key points.

Rewrite Information: I organized and expressed my own ideas without copying others work.

Modify Sentence Structure: I changed the sentences but kept the actual meaning the same.

Include Personal Understanding: I included my own analysis to show a clear understanding of the topic.

Provide References: I used proper citations for information collected from different sources.

3.2 Take an Active Part in Seminars, Discussions and Tutorials on Academic Topics.

Take Notes: I recorded important ideas and feedback from seminars and tutorials.

Strategies for Active Participation:

Prepare Before Discussion: I studied the topic of journaling before the discussion so that I could understand it better and speak with confidence.

Listen Carefully: I listened carefully to others' ideas and tried to remember the important points.

Respect Others' Opinions: I respected others' opinions and communicated with everyone politely.

Share My Ideas: I shared my knowledge and some examples about journaling and its benefits.

Participate in Discussion: I tried to balance listening and sharing my own thoughts during the discussion.

Ask Questions: I asked questions when I did not understand something clearly, so that I could improve my understanding.

3.3 Collect, Analyse, Interpret and Present Information from Lectures, Talks And Discussions

I follow four simple steps to collect and use information from lectures and discussions:

Collect Information: During lectures or discussions, I take short notes of the important points.

Review and Understand Information: I read my notes again to understand the main points and compare them with other information if needed.

Understand the Topic: I connect new ideas with my previous knowledge to understand the topic more clearly.

Present Information: Finally, I organize the important points and present them using simple summaries, tables, or charts.

Learning Outcome # 4

Be able to use ICT Resources for information Gathering.

4.1 Use the internet for research.

Use the Internet for Research

Academic Search: I used Google Scholar and trusted websites to find information about journaling.

Relevant Keywords: I searched using keywords such as “journaling for students” and “benefits of journaling”.

Reliable Sources: I selected reliable and relevant articles related to my research topic.

Check Information: I compared information from different sources to ensure accuracy.

Recent Sources: I used recent articles to support my research.

Harvard Referencing: I used the Harvard Referencing System for all sources included in my assignment.

4.2 Gather and evaluate resources relevant to Professional activities.

Collecting and evaluating information is very important because it helps to find accurate and reliable information. It also makes research work easier and more effective.

1.Tools for Gathering Information

Google Scholar and Trusted Websites: I've used Google Scholar and various trusted websites to gather information about journaling.

Academic Articles: I selected online articles and journals related to my research topic.

2.Evaluating Resources

Relevance: I presented the benefits of journaling with logical arguments in the information I used.

Credibility: I have collected information from various reliable websites and academic journals written by reliable authors.

Accuracy Check: To ensure the accuracy of the information, I cross-checked it with data from various sources.

Practical Example: I used Google Scholar and trusted websites to get the required information for my assignment. Then, I organized the details properly and used Harvard referencing to make my research more reliable.

4.3 Use computer software to organize and Communicate information for arrange of audiences.

Software Tools Overview

Using modern software tools, we can easily organize data, create new documents, and present our work in a beautiful way. As a result, all kinds of work, whether academic or professional, can be done very easily and well. (Kumar, 2025)

Software Tools Table

Tool	Purpose	Example Use Case
Word Processor	Create and edit documents	Writing reports and assignments
Spreadsheet	Organize and analyse data	Creating tables, charts, and calculations
Database	Store and manage information	Managing records and data
Graphics Software	Create visual content	Making diagrams and infographics
Multimedia Software	Create audio and video presentations	Preparing presentations and training materials

(LearnFree, 2016)

Conclusion

In Conclusion, journaling is a good habit. It helps students to improve their self-esteem, reduce stress, and improve self-esteem. In this assignment, I learned many things, like doing my research, writing neatly, giving references in Harvard style, and using computers or ICT. They will be of great use to me in the future.

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